FJ 10310/12

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United Kingdom Liaison Mission in Japan,

TOKYO.

CONFIDENTIAL
(1030/7/52)

14th January, 1952.

Dear Ro,

FJ10310/14

The Secretary of State's telegram No. 107 of 10th January, repeated to me as telegram No. 30 of 11th January, only reached me this afternoon. I am not sure whether any instructions will follow it, and I shall in any case be telegraphing, but as the bag is leaving this afternoon you may care to have my views at somewhat greater length than would be possible in a telegram.

I take it that the Americans intend to go on putting pressure on the Japanese, and that they hope the latter will give way to the extent of letting it be known that they will conclude a treaty with Chiang Kai-shek as soon as they become sovereign. The damage which this will do will, of course, be in no way reduced by the fact that the act will only take place when the Treaty comes into force, for the whole world and particularly the Japanese people will know that Japan has succumbed to American pressure. If I am instructed to say to Yoshida what is contained in the Washington telegram, we shall at any rate be exonerated from having been parties to the American action. But that won't do the Americans any good in their relations with the Japanese, and in the last analysis that is what counts perhaps more than anything else. But I would agree that there is a limit to what we can do to hold the Americans in check.

As far as my thoughts take me on a bag day, I should not feel inclined to seek an interview with Yoshida because that can hardly fail to attract a great deal of attention. It might be better to say nothing at all to him unless he himself raises the subject, and he has so far not shown himself very eager to seek for other people's opinions. On the other hand, the Secretary of State may feel that unless I say something to him our position will go by default, and there is a good deal in that.

One Shigeharu Matsumoto was dining with me last night to meet Montgomery Hyde. (He told me he knew you in Shanghai where he was the Domei representative before the war). In the course of conversation after dinner the question of the two Chinas came up, and I said that I understood Yoshida's attitude to be that Japan could not do anything unless and until the United Kingdom and the United/

R. H. Scott, Esq., C.M.G., C.B.E.,

Foreign Office.

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United States agreed upon their China policy. I must have seemed to suggest that I thought this was just an excuse on Yoshida's part, for Matsumoto said that he had seen Yoshida recently and that strangely enough he believed him to be entirely sincere. He added that Yoshida had his own rather peculiar ideas about China, and this seemed to be part of his general outlook. Matsumoto then gave it as his own view that Japan would probably recognise neither Chinese Government. This is just a sidelight from an intelligent observer who, from time to time, is talked of as a possible Ambassador to London.

I see from the Washington telegram that Dulles continues to harp on the fact that all Japan is being asked to do is to make "arrangements" with Chiang Kai-shek that will be limited to Formosa. But Matsumoto, in our conversation last night, raised precisely the point which I raised with Dulles, namely how is one to define Chiang Kai-shek's government in coming to any agreement. It appeared that this seemed to him as insuperable a difficulty as it seems to me. Dulles offered no solution when he was here, and I have not heard of one since. The particular point which Matsumoto raised was in connection with the termination of the state of war which, he said, Japan would be very glad to have. But with what government would the state of war be terminated?

My view still remains that the Japanese will dislike intensely being forced into an agreement with Chiang Kai-shek. But they may succumb if the pressure is strong enough, and in that event they will harbour strong resentment against the United States. The position of Yoshida's government will be weakened because it will have demonstrably given way to United States dictation, and a handle will be given to Communist as well as Right Wing propaganda. Dulles should realise all this, but American minds only seem attuned to the immediate, and they dislike looking into the future.

Yours ever,

Bill Hayter

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